title: "End Of Life Care Policy" effectiveDate: "" reviewDate: "" version: "1.0"

End-of-Life Care Policy

Policy Title: End-of-Life Care

Effective Date: [Insert Date]

Review Date: [Insert Date – usually annually]

Version: 1.0

Applies to: All residents, staff, agency workers, and volunteers at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

1. Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we are committed to delivering compassionate, person-centred, and dignified care to residents approaching the end of life. Our approach is guided by respect for residents' wishes, cultural and spiritual needs, and the involvement of families and loved ones.

We aim to:

- Provide high-quality care that maximises comfort and quality of life.
- Support residents to make informed choices about their care.
- Work in partnership with healthcare professionals, families, and advocates.
- Ensure staff are trained and confident in end-of-life care.
- Comply with CQC Fundamental Standards, the Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014, and NICE guidance.

2. Purpose

This policy sets out how [INSERT CARE HOME NAME] will:

- Support residents in advance care planning.
- Provide appropriate palliative and end-of-life care.
- Ensure effective communication with residents and families.
- Deliver care that respects dignity, rights, and individual choice.

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- Residents – all individuals receiving care in the home.
- Staff – all care, nursing, and support staff.

- Families and Visitors – who will be supported throughout the process.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Ensures policy implementation and staff training.
- Oversees partnership working with GPs, district nurses, palliative care teams, and hospices.
- Monitors care standards and compliance with guidance.

Nurses / Senior Care Staff:

- Coordinate end-of-life care and ensure care plans are followed.
- Facilitate advance care planning discussions with residents and families.
- Administer palliative treatments as prescribed.

All Staff:

- Provide compassionate care in line with residents' care plans.
- Report changes in residents' condition promptly.
- Support families and respect residents' preferences.

5. Advance Care Planning

- On admission, and regularly thereafter, residents will be offered the opportunity to discuss their wishes for end-of-life care.
- Advance Decisions to Refuse Treatment (ADRT) and Do Not Attempt Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation (DNACPR) forms will be respected where valid and applicable.
- Care plans will include residents' cultural, spiritual, and personal preferences.

6. Palliative and End-of-Life Care

- Care focuses on comfort, dignity, and quality of life, not solely medical treatment.
- Pain and symptom management will be prioritised, with referrals to palliative care teams as needed.
- Emotional, spiritual, and psychological support offered to residents and families.
- Residents will never be denied food, drink, or basic comfort unless clinically advised.

7. Communication

- Open, sensitive, and honest communication will be maintained with residents and families.
- Residents and families will be kept informed of changes in condition and care decisions.
- Cultural and language needs will be respected in all communication.

8. After-Death Care

- Care of the deceased carried out respectfully, in line with cultural and spiritual needs.
- Families supported with privacy and compassion.
- Relevant notifications made to GP, coroner (if required), and other agencies.
- Staff offered debrief and emotional support.

9. Monitoring and Review

- End-of-life care practices will be reviewed regularly through audits and case reviews.

- Feedback will be sought from residents (where appropriate), families, and staff.
- Lessons learned will be used to continuously improve practice.

10. Training

- All staff will receive training in:
    - Palliative and end-of-life care.
    - Communication skills and supporting families.
    - Symptom management and recognising signs of approaching death.
- Refresher training provided annually or as guidance updates.

11. References

- NICE Quality Standard QS13: End-of-Life Care for Adults
- NICE Guideline NG31: Care of dying adults in the last days of life
- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- CQC Fundamental Standards – Regulation 9 (Person-centred care) & Regulation 12 (Safe care and treatment)
- General Medical Council – Treatment and care towards the end of life: good practice in decision-making

12. Related Policies

- Mental Capacity Act & DoLS Policy
- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Mental Health & Wellbeing Policy
- Equality, Diversity & Inclusion Policy
- Record Keeping / Confidentiality / GDPR Policy
- Training & Development / Supervision Policy

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